

Phase_H_Architecture_Change_Management

TOGAF ADM - Phase H: Architecture Change Management

Purpose: Keep architecture aligned with changing requirements

Overview

PHASE H: ARCHITECTURE CHANGE MANAGEMENT

"How do we keep the architecture relevant as things change?"
"How do we manage changes to the approved architecture?"

Key Activities

PHASE H: KEY ACTIVITIES

1. MONITOR TECHNOLOGY CHANGES

- New technologies (AWS new services, new frameworks)
- End-of-Life (Java 11 EOL, deprecated libraries)
- Security vulnerabilities (CVEs, patches)
- Vendor changes (pricing, acquisitions)

2. MONITOR BUSINESS CHANGES

- Strategy changes (new products, new markets)
- Regulatory changes (DPDPA, GDPR, gaming compliance)
- Organizational changes (new teams, M&A)
- Market changes (competitors, customer needs)

3. MANAGE ARCHITECTURE CHANGE REQUESTS

- └─ Receive change requests from teams
- └─ Classify (Minor / Incremental / Major / Emergency)
- └─ Assess impact (systems, cost, risk)
- └─ Approve / Reject / Defer
- └─ Update architecture documents

Types of Changes

TYPES OF ARCHITECTURE CHANGES
1. SIMPLIFICATION CHANGES └─ Reduce complexity, improve efficiency - Example: Consolidate 3 databases into 1 2. INCREMENTAL CHANGES └─ Small improvements within current architecture - Example: Add a new field to an API 3. RE-ARCHITECTING CHANGES └─ Major changes to architecture approach - Example: Move from monolith to microservices 4. EMERGENCY CHANGES └─ Urgent fixes for critical issues - Example: Security vulnerability patch

Architecture Change Request (ACR)

ARCHITECTURE CHANGE REQUEST (ACR)
WHAT IT IS: A formal request to modify the approved architecture ACR TEMPLATE: ACR ID: ACR-2024-042 Title: Add Redis caching layer Requestor: Payment Team Date: 2024-01-15

Description:

Add Redis cache to reduce database load for payment lookups

Reason/Driver:

Current latency is 500ms, target is 100ms

Impact:

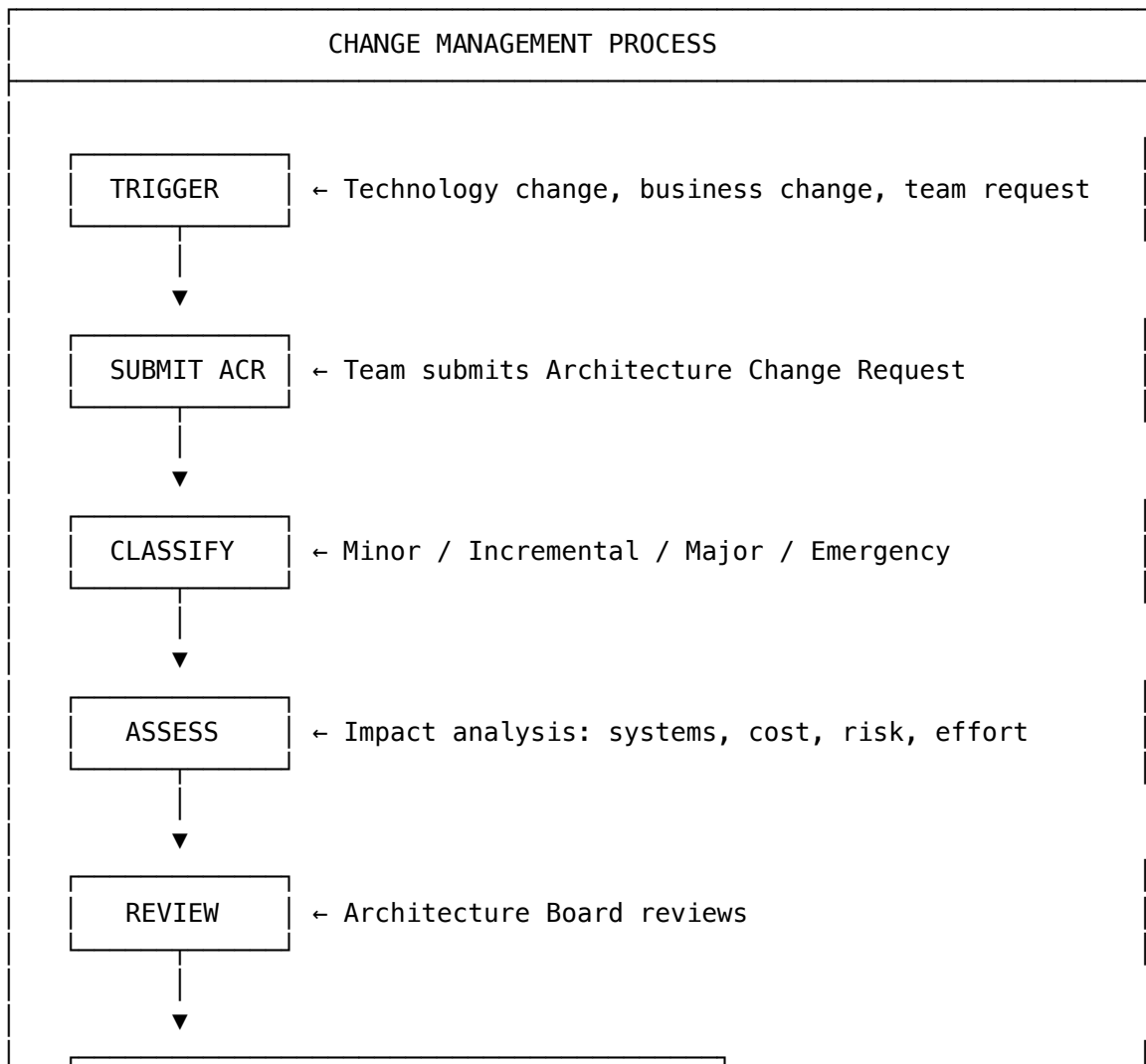
- New infrastructure component
- Code changes in Payment Service
- Additional monitoring required

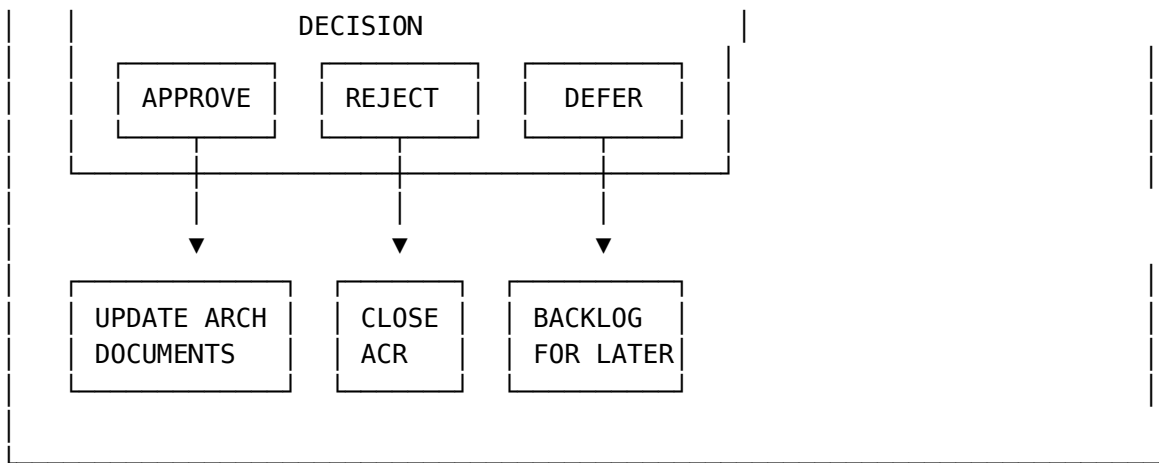
Effort: 2 weeks, 2 engineers

Risk: Low

Status: Pending Review

Change Management Process





When to Start New ADM Cycle

WHEN TO START NEW ADM CYCLE
Phase H may trigger a NEW ADM cycle when: 1. MAJOR BUSINESS CHANGE └ New product line, M&A, major strategy shift 2. SIGNIFICANT TECHNOLOGY SHIFT └ Cloud migration, platform change, major upgrade 3. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS └ New compliance needs (GDPR, DPDPA, industry regulations) 4. ARCHITECTURE DRIFT └ Current state has drifted too far from target 5. TARGET ACHIEVED └ Current target reached, time to define new target Phase H → (triggers) → Phase A (new cycle) This is why ADM is ITERATIVE!

Architecture Refresh

ARCHITECTURE REFRESH
WHAT IT IS: Periodic review and update of architecture FREQUENCY: • Annual review (minimum) • Quarterly for fast-changing domains WHAT TO REVIEW: • Are architecture principles still valid? • Is target state still relevant? • What technology changes need attention? • What business changes need attention? • Is the roadmap still on track? OUTPUT: • Updated Architecture Vision (if needed) • Updated Roadmap • New ADM cycle (if major changes)

Key Deliverables

Deliverable	Description
Architecture Updates	Updated documentation reflecting changes
Change Requests	ACRs submitted and processed
Governance Log	Record of all changes and decisions
Dispensation Updates	Review and update of existing dispensations
New ADM Cycle (if needed)	Trigger for Phase A if major change

Summary

PHASE H = "KEEP ARCHITECTURE ALIVE" • Monitor technology changes (new tech, EOL, vulnerabilities) • Monitor business changes (strategy, regulations, market) • Manage change requests (ACRs)

- Update architecture documents
- Trigger new ADM cycle when needed

OUTPUT: Architecture Updates + Change Requests + Governance Log

Without Phase H, architecture becomes outdated and irrelevant!